

the world—Apple, Microsoft, Tata, Reliance—were not built in 5-7 years. They took decades. We need venture models that are willing to underwrite 20-year journeys, not just quick exits. India's next wave of winners will not be copy-paste models of the West. They will solve for India's unique challenges, and they will need patient capital and technical mentorship.

In a world marked by increasing geopolitical uncertainty, defence technology is not optional for India—it is an imperative. We can no

longer rely solely on imported solutions to safeguard our sovereignty. We need Indian start-ups building the next generation of defence technologies—from autonomous drones and AI-powered surveillance systems to space-tech solutions and quantum security infrastructure. This requires patient capital, risk tolerance, and a willingness to back bold, transformative ideas that may take a decade or more to mature.

To build an India that is self-reliant, resilient, and globally competitive, we must also embrace

domestic capital as the backbone of this transformation. While global investors have been instrumental in fueling India's early-stage ecosystem, it's time for Indian family offices, institutions, insurance companies, retirement funds, and sovereign funds to step up and back the funders and entrepreneurs who are solving for India. We need to see more Indian LPs (limited partnership) in domestic funds and a mindset shift towards long-duration capital. For too long, Indian start-ups have looked at IPOs as the distant dream.

But as we've seen with companies like Zomato, Nykaa, Policybazaar, and many more on the cusp, the public markets are now ready for new-age companies. It's time we encourage founders to build for the public markets, to list in India, and to let Indian retail investors participate in their growth stories. When start-ups IPO in India, they not only access deeper capital pools but also inspire millions of Indians to dream bigger.

As we reimagine venture investing, we must ask: Are we backing visionaries solving India's toughest challenges or chasing quick exits?

Let's build a start-up ecosystem that prioritises profitability over hype, impact over vanity, and innovation over imitation—one that is by India, for India, and for the world. That's the future I am excited about. That's the future we at Titan Capital are committed to building.

This is our moment to invest boldly, thoughtfully, and with conviction. Let's build a future where 'Indicorns' are the norm, not the exception, and where India@100 is defined by innovation, inclusivity, and enduring value creation. **BT**

Views are personal

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